Service Manager Email Operating System

Jeff Pursley | Real-world configuration and troubleshooting | September - October 2026 | Public summary

The operational problem

A service manager working in the field needs a reliable view of customer escalations, vendor issues, staff questions and work still pending. Standard unread and starred email flags do not reliably show the next owner or when a task is complete.

What I configured and refined

Configured and troubleshot Google Workspace Studio and Gemini flows for classification, ownership labels, urgent messages and scheduled Google Chat operations briefs. Documented the state model, open-loop policy and validation cases.

One especially important failure case was treating an outgoing reply as proof the manager was now waiting on someone else. The corrected policy evaluates the full thread and any remaining work before changing the state.

How decisions remain controlled

Use exactly one primary workflow state: ACTION, WAITING, FOLLOW_UP, INFO, RESOLVED or NEEDS_REVIEW. Urgency is a separate overlay. Keep the identity/source labels separate from the next-action state.

Escalate ambiguous cases to review. Do not authorize deletion, customer communication, closure or high-impact operational decisions merely because the language model inferred them.

Status and privacy

The work involved real configuration and troubleshooting, with operational policies and testing plans developed. Audited savings, final deployment scope and production accuracy are not independently verified. No private emails, contact directory, credentials or confidential operational details are included.